

The Boston Globe

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A forgotten blast, a painful reminder

Loss of leg haunts victim of courthouse bombing 50 years ago



GLOBE FILE

Nearly two dozen people were injured in the explosion on the second floor of the Suffolk County Courthouse.

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

On the morning of April 22, 1976, Edmund Narine briskly climbed the steps of the Suffolk County Courthouse. He was in his late 30s, physically fit, and working days while taking night classes as he tried to build a steady life in Boston after leaving Trinidad a few years earlier.

He had a simple errand that morning — to pick up some paperwork to get a license to drive a cab. While waiting in line, he struck up a conversation with a man from Alabama to pass the time.

That's when the bomb went off, ripping through the probation department office on the second floor.

"It's inconceivable that somebody would put a bomb in a public place like that," Narine, 88, said at his Brockton



ANDREW BURKE-STEVENSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

"It's inconceivable that somebody would put a bomb in a public place like that," Edmund Narine said.

home.

The bombing, which investigators later linked to a broader series of attacks across New England in the months that followed, came at a volatile time in Boston, as the city grappled with racial tensions from school desegregation, economic decline, and deep uncertainty about the future.

Nearly two dozen people were injured in the blast, and while the attack has largely faded into history, for victims such as Narine the consequences have lasted for decades.

The explosion, fueled by at least six sticks of dynamite, ripped apart the courthouse's second floor, just feet away from where Narine was in line.

"I was close to it . . . too close," he said, sitting in his living room alongside

BOMBING, Page A10

DHS post of Fenway image pushes buttons

Some see picture as a possible nod to far-right groups

By Jim Puzzanghera,
Tal Kopan, and Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The social media post by the Department of Homeland Security Tuesday night seemed to come out of left field: an idyllic image of Fenway Park at sunset under the words "Worth Fighting For."

But given the aggressive immigration enforcement tactics under

President Trump, and the department's recent history of posting memes of gauzy American images and references popular with white supremacists, those were fighting words for many New Englanders — especially Red Sox fans.

Hundreds of negative comments flooded the DHS post after it appeared at 6:30 p.m. on X, formerly Twitter, about 15 minutes before the first pitch in the nationally televised Sox-Yankees game.

The post also caught the attention of Massachusetts politicians who strongly oppose the controversial tactics of the DHS's Immigration and Customs Enforcement

agency.

"This is our [expletive] city, and nobody is going to dictate our freedom," Representative Seth Moulton, a Salem Democrat, wrote on his repost of the DHS meme. His comment echoed David Ortiz's famous declaration in the first Sox game at Fenway after the 2013 Marathon bombing.

"They're trying to get under our skin, and they're trying to poke us to see if we're willing to stand up," Moulton told the Globe Wednesday. "And we need to show that we as a city and as a community are not going to take this [expletive]. We're going to stand up."

A Red Sox spokesperson declined to comment on the controversy but said the team had no involvement in the post. (The Globe is owned by Red Sox owner John Henry.)

It's unclear exactly why DHS posted the Fenway image, under the words "Our nation and our people are worth fighting for."

"America's homeland and the rich heritage of its national pastime should fill every citizen with a sense of pride," said a DHS spokesperson in response to Globe questions. "Our unique achievements in sports and culture are worth defending,

FENWAY, Page A6

Mills's campaign slow to catch fire

Maine governor wages low-key fight for Senate as Platner draws crowds

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

SCARBOROUGH, Maine — When Governor Janet Mills stepped into the monthly meeting of Democrats here last Thursday night, it was a seemingly invaluable chance for voters to hear directly about her campaign for Senate with the June primary just weeks away.

Democratic voters' interest in the race couldn't be higher: Whether they can finally defeat Republican Senator Susan Collins is, yet again, a question with massive implications for the balance of power in Washington.

Their interest in Mills is potentially a different story. Only a few dozen voters showed up in Scarborough — a fast-growing suburb of Portland — to hear the governor's stump speech and ask questions.

Jan Paradie, a Democratic voter from nearby Saco, believes Mills has what it takes to defeat Collins. But she was surprised and a bit concerned at the low turnout.

"She needs to get a bigger audience, more exposure," Paradie said, as she left the meeting.

The scene captured an emerging reality of Maine's closely watched Senate primary: Mills, a

MAINE, Page A6

Shortsleeve brought change, controversy in years at T

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

When Brian Shortsleeve arrived at the Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority in July 2015, longtime staff immediately felt something shift.

All of a sudden, PowerPoint presentations full of bar charts infiltrated meetings. Vest-clad analysts sized up departments team by team. Administrators started using Agile and Scrum, a project management framework common in the private sector. The office space for big problem-solving meetings got rebranded as a "war room."

"It was like Bain came to the T," said Brian Kane, who led the T's operations department at the time and now is the executive director of the MBTA Advisory Board.

Shortsleeve had no transportation background when then-governor Charlie Baker plucked him from the private sector to become the agency's first "chief administrator." But he did have a big challenge: His mandate was to slash the T's budget deficit and professionalize what was easily the most high-profile, and scrutinized, agency in Massachusetts.

SHORTSLEEVE, Page A7

Area man hopes to turn hate into humor



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE 2025

Ben Collins said The Onion has the backing of Sandy Hook families.

Onion CEO confident he can take over Infowars this time

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The Onion attempted its greatest bit ever when it planned in 2024 to buy Infowars, the right-wing site run by conspiracy theorist Alex Jones, only to later be thwarted by the humorless process of bankruptcy court.

Seventeen months later, Massachusetts native and The Onion's chief executive Ben Collins is confident that a new deal announced Monday will help his outlet land the joke.

"Last time, we were kind of flying blind," Collins said in an interview Tuesday. "Now we have bankruptcy lawyers . . . we know what we're doing and we're in a much better spot."

The Onion's plan to take over Infowars

THE ONION, Page A10

Iran fired on three vessels in the Strait of Hormuz and seized two of them, intensifying its assault on shipping in the key waterway. **A3.**

Frustrated Boston residents demanded city officials take action on a number of street projects that have been stalled for more than a year. **B1.**

Boston College received its largest donation ever, \$125 million, from the Patrick F. Cadigan Family Foundation to renovate Carney Hall. **B1.**

A report showing the efficacy of the COVID-19 vaccine has reportedly been blocked from being published in the CDC's flagship scientific journal. **A2.**

Greater Boston ranks among the top potential destinations for recent college graduates and early career professionals, according to an analysis by Redfin and Glassdoor. **D1.**



OK bloomer

Thursday: Showers, warmer. High 62-67. Low 40-45.

Friday: Sunny, cooler. High 50-55. Low 39-44.

High tide: 4:23 a.m., 5:15 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:51 Sunset: 7:35

Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

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